

Guide: from template to a file your printer accepts first time

Label Kit · 36 label templates (12 formats × 3 styles) · Illustrator CC 2020+ (also Affinity Designer, Inkscape, Figma)

1. Open the template

1. Open the `.svg` (or the `.pdf` in `templates-pdf/`) with **File > Open**, not Place. Illustrator turns the top-level groups into layers.
2. If you see a single layer, select the group in the Layers panel and use **Release to Layers (Sequence)**. Or just work inside the groups: they are already named.
3. Check **File > Document Setup**: units in millimetres, colour mode **CMYK**.

Every template is trim size + 3 mm bleed on each side. The artboard is already the right size: **do not resize it**.

2. Layers

Layer	Colour	Contents	Print?
GRAFICA	—	Background, pattern, illustrations, logo. Anything coloured must run to the outer magenta line.	Yes
TESTI	—	Name, claim, INCI, warnings, net content. Keep inside the green line.	Yes
SIMBOLI	—	Placeholders for PAO, e, recycling. Paste the files from <code>simboli/</code> .	Yes
AREA_SICURA	green dashed	3 mm safe area from the cut.	No: hide
FUSTELLA	cyan	Cut line. Some printers want it as a spot colour "CutContour" set to overprint, others want it removed. Ask.	Depends
ABBONDANZA	magenta dashed	3 mm bleed boundary. Reference only.	No: hide
CROCINI	black	Crop marks. If you export with Illustrator's "Trim Marks", hide these.	One of the two
NOTE	grey	Reminders for you.	No: hide

3. The 7 rules that stop your printer sending the file back

1. **3 mm bleed.** Backgrounds must reach the magenta line. A thin white edge after cutting is the most common defect.
2. **3 mm safe area.** Text and logos inside the green line. Die-cutting can shift by 1 mm.
3. **CMYK, not RGB.** Bright RGB greens and oranges go dull in CMYK. Work in CMYK from the start.
4. **Rich black only for solid areas** (C60 M40 Y40 K100). Text in pure K100. Never small text in rich black.
5. **Small text: minimum 1.2 mm x-height** (about 5–6 pt). Mandatory for food and supplements (Reg. 1169/2011); best practice for cosmetics.
6. **Outline fonts** only in the copy you send to print (Type > Create Outlines). Keep a live-text master.
7. **Images at 300 dpi** at final size, embedded. No 72 dpi PNGs from Instagram.

4. Export the PDF

1. Hide AREA_SICURA, ABBONDANZA, NOTE. Decide FUSTELLA and CROCINI (table above).
2. **File > Save As > Adobe PDF**, preset **[PDF/X-4:2008]** (PDF/X-1a if the printer insists).
3. **Marks and Bleeds:** bleed **3 mm** on all sides. Trim marks on if you hid the CROCINI layer.
4. **Output:** "Convert to Destination (Preserve Numbers)", profile **Coated FOGRA39** for coated paper or PP; **Uncoated FOGRA29** for natural paper. In the US use **U.S. Web Coated (SWOP)** or **GRACoL** as your printer specifies.
5. Name it `brand_product_format_PRINT.pdf`. Open the PDF and check edges and small text at 400 %.

Spot colours and white ink. Clear or metallic labels need a white underprint layer (spot "White", overprint). Hot-foil gold or silver needs a spot "Foil". Ask the printer how they want them named before you set them up.

5. What to send the printer

- ☐ PDF/X with bleed
- ☐ Quantity, material (white PP, natural paper, clear PP...), finish (matte, gloss, soft touch)
- ☐ Trim size in mm and shape (rectangle with 2 mm radius, Ø 60 round, ...)
- ☐ For wrap labels: container diameter and wrap direction
- ☐ Rolls or sheets? For rolls: core diameter and unwind orientation
- ☐ Always ask for a **proof** before the full run

6. Material quick pick

Product	Material	Why
Creams, serums, shower gels	White or clear PP + lamination	Water, oil and rub resistant
Candles	PP or coated paper, matte lamination	Heat and wax. Avoid unprotected natural paper
Soaps, "natural" cosmetics	Natural / kraft paper with varnish	Touch and artisan feel. Not for shower products
Supplements (jar)	Gloss white PP	Clean, pharma look, crisp small text
Pouches	Direct print or PP label	Check adhesion on the pouch surface

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